

Winter



What good is the warmth of summer, without the cold of winter to give it sweetness?

John Steinbeck

Winter is a fascinating time of year – Bits and Pieces from the Met Office

- ❖ Winter is coming - but when? Astronomically at the equinox, 21/22 December or meteorologically on 1 December.
- ❖ Did you know that Earth is closest to the Sun in winter? In the northern hemisphere at *perihelion* (*peri* - near and *helio* - sun) around 3 January when the Earth is 3.1 million miles closer to the Sun than at *aphelion* around 5 July.
- ❖ The coldest temperature ever recorded in winter was -27.2 °C recorded in the Scottish Highlands, in Braemar on 11 February 1895 and again on 10 January 1982, and in Altnaharra on 30 December.
- ❖ The winter of 1963 is one of the coldest on record. Temperatures consistently reached lower than -20 °C with blizzards, snowdrifts and even the sea freezing around the coast.
- ❖ Remember it well! It started at Christmas 1962. Blizzards left huge snowdrifts and, with snow continuing to fall, it was still around in March. Are you one of those lucky enough to remember the winter of 1947?
- ❖ The word winter comes from the Germanic *winter* signifying a wet season.
- ❖ So how old are you? In Anglo-Saxon cultures, years were counted by the winters, so a person could be said to be '2 winters old'.
- ❖ Some reindeer living above the Arctic Circle live in complete darkness for several weeks of the year. A small area of tissue behind the retina changes colour from gold in summer to blue in winter allowing the reindeer's eyes to see in the dark.

→
Blue

Winter

Did you catch the Wolf Moon on 10 January? So bright when it rose. And did you see the lunar eclipse as the Earth cast its shadow across the face of the moon.



And did you know?



A bright first Moon promises rain and a bountiful harvest; a red-tinted Moon means a dry year.

We had both!! Our Wolf moon was tinted red by the setting sun, I think!

A halo around the Moon predicts wet or stormy weather.

Our next full moon known as the Snow Moon is on February 9th

**D'you think when we're in February we'll be able to sing
Christina Rosetti's . . . ?**

7
In the bleak midwinter
Frosty wind made moan,
Earth stood hard as iron,
Water like a stone;
Snow had fallen, snow on snow,
Snow on snow,
In the bleak midwinter, long ago.



Winter

Mud, mud, glorious mud.

Nothing quite like it for cooling the blood.

So follow me, follow. Down to the hollow. And there let us
wallow in glorious mud. *Flanders and Swann*

So much rain!

Ground is so waterlogged we're all
taking the long-way round to get to
school and Sandhills and Thornhill.
But some love the muddy puddles.



And at last:



Lucky to have 5 or 6 matches on Saturday 11th January, after weeks of not being
able to play because of the wet ground conditions.

Risinghurst and Sandhills Parish Council Winter 2019/2020
www.risinghurstsandhillsparishcouncil.com

Winter

So it's Leap Year

Wikipedia says, "In Ireland and Britain, it is a tradition that women may propose marriage only in leap years.

While it has been claimed that the tradition was initiated by Saint Patrick or Brigid of Kildare in 5th century Ireland, this is dubious, as the tradition has not been attested before the 19th century.



Supposedly, a 1288 law by Queen Margaret of Scotland (then aged five and living in Norway), required that fines be levied if a marriage proposal was refused by the man; compensation was deemed to be a pair of leather gloves, a single rose, £1 and a kiss."

Lerwick Town Hall depicting Margaret, queen of Scotland and daughter of Norway



Some years ago your Groundsman was trapped on this mountain, Fleetwith Pike, on 29th February
Nowadays we women are restricted to Leap Day



A steep climb ahead (specially with fingers crossed)



At last the summit and he hadn't run off down the other side!

So it was Happily Ever After!